

MATH 350-2 Advanced Calculus

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Outline

- 1 Real Analysis Lecture 15
 - Limit of a function
 - Continuity

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Limit of a function

Let (S, d_S) and (T, d_T) be metric spaces and $A \subseteq S$.

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$$\lim_{x \rightarrow p} f(x) = L$$

if for all $\epsilon > 0$ there exists $\delta > 0$ such that

$$0 < d_S(x, p) < \delta \Rightarrow d_T(f(x), L) < \epsilon.$$

Example

Prove that

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 3} \frac{1}{x^2} = \frac{1}{9}$$

Example

Prove that

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow 4} \frac{\sqrt{x} - 2}{x - 4} = \frac{1}{4}$$

Limit of a function

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Limit of a function

Theorem

Let (S, d_S) and (T, d_T) be metric spaces, $A \subseteq S$, and $f : A \rightarrow T$ be a function. Then

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow a} f(x) = L$$

if and only if

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f(x_n) = L$$

for all sequences $\{x_n\}$ of values in $A \setminus \{a\}$ which converge to a .

Challenge!

Consider the function

$$f : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$$

between metric spaces with the Euclidean metric defined by

$$f(x, y) = \frac{x^2 y}{x^4 + y^2}.$$

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Question

What is the limit as $(x, y) \rightarrow (0, 0)$?

Challenge!

Consider the sequence $\{(x_n, y_n)\}$ defined by

$$(x_n, y_n) = (1/n, 0).$$

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and

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f(x_n, y_n) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1/n^3}{1/n^4 + 1/n^2} = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1/n}{1/n^2 + 1} = 0.$$

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The limit DOES NOT EXIST!

Limit of a function

Proof.

($\Rightarrow$) Suppose that $\lim_{x \rightarrow a} f(x) = L$ and let $\{x_n\}$ be a sequence of values in $A \setminus \{a\}$ which converges to a .

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Then there exists $\delta > 0$ such that $0 < d_S(x, a) < \delta$ implies $d_T(f(x), L) < \epsilon$.

Also, there exists $N \in \mathbb{Z}_+$ such that $n \geq N$ implies $d_S(x_n, a) < \delta$ for all $n \geq N$.

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Also, there exists $N \in \mathbb{Z}_+$ such that $n \geq N$ implies $d_S(x_n, a) < \delta$ for all $n \geq N$.

Therefore since $x_n \neq a$ for all n , we have that

$$n \geq N \Rightarrow 0 < d_S(x_n, a) < \delta \Rightarrow d_T(f(x_n), L) < \epsilon.$$

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Hence for all $n \geq N$, we know $d_T(f(x_n), L) < \epsilon$.

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($\Rightarrow$) Suppose that $\lim_{x \rightarrow a} f(x) = L$ and let $\{x_n\}$ be a sequence of values in $A \setminus \{a\}$ which converges to a .

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Hence for all $n \geq N$, we know $d_T(f(x_n), L) < \epsilon$.

Since $\epsilon > 0$ was arbitrary, this proves $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f(x_n) = L$. □

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($\Leftarrow$) Suppose that for every sequence $\{x_n\}$ of values in $A \setminus \{a\}$ which converges to a , we have $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f(x_n) = L$.

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($\Leftarrow$) Suppose that for every sequence $\{x_n\}$ of values in $A \setminus \{a\}$ which converges to a , we have $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f(x_n) = L$. We must show that $\lim_{x \rightarrow a} f(x) = L$.

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To see this, we assume otherwise.

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Then there exists $\epsilon > 0$ such that for all $\delta > 0$ there exists x with $0 < d_S(x, a) < \delta$ and $d_T(f(x), L) \geq \epsilon$.

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Then there exists $\epsilon > 0$ such that for all $\delta > 0$ there exists x with $0 < d_S(x, a) < \delta$ and $d_T(f(x), L) \geq \epsilon$.

For each $n \in \mathbb{Z}_+$, take $x_n \in A$ with $0 < d_S(x_n, a) < 1/n$ and $d_T(f(x_n), L) \geq \epsilon$.

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In this case, $\{x_n\}$ is a sequence of values in $A \setminus \{a\}$ which converges to a .

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In this case, $\{x_n\}$ is a sequence of values in $A \setminus \{a\}$ which converges to a .

However, $\{f(x_n)\}$ never gets closer than ϵ to L , so it cannot converge to L .

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To see this, we assume otherwise.

Then there exists $\epsilon > 0$ such that for all $\delta > 0$ there exists x with $0 < d_S(x, a) < \delta$ and $d_T(f(x), L) \geq \epsilon$.

For each $n \in \mathbb{Z}_+$, take $x_n \in A$ with $0 < d_S(x_n, a) < 1/n$ and $d_T(f(x_n), L) \geq \epsilon$.

In this case, $\{x_n\}$ is a sequence of values in $A \setminus \{a\}$ which converges to a .

However, $\{f(x_n)\}$ never gets closer than ϵ to L , so it cannot converge to L .

This is a contradiction. □

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- 1 Real Analysis Lecture 15
 - Limit of a function
 - Continuity

Continuity

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Let (S, d_S) and (T, d_T) be metric spaces and $f : S \rightarrow T$ a function.

Definition

Then f is continuous at a point $p \in S$ if for all $\epsilon > 0$ there exists $\delta > 0$ such that

$$d_S(x, p) < \delta \Rightarrow d_T(f(x), f(p)) < \epsilon.$$

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Equivalently, $f(B_S(p; \delta)) \subseteq B_T(f(p); \epsilon)$.

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Equivalently, $f(B_S(p; \delta)) \subseteq B_T(f(p); \epsilon)$. We say f is continuous on $A \subseteq S$ if $f(x)$ is continuous at every point $p \in A$.

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Then f is continuous at a point $p \in S$ if for all $\epsilon > 0$ there exists $\delta > 0$ such that

$$d_S(x, p) < \delta \Rightarrow d_T(f(x), f(p)) < \epsilon.$$

Equivalently, $f(B_S(p; \delta)) \subseteq B_T(f(p); \epsilon)$. We say f is continuous on $A \subseteq S$ if $f(x)$ is continuous at every point $p \in A$. If f is continuous on S , we simply say f is continuous.

Sequence version

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Theorem

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Sequence version

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Let (S, d_S) and (T, d_T) be metric spaces and $f : S \rightarrow T$ a function. Then f is continuous at a point p in S if for all sequences $\{x_n\}$ of values in S which converge to p , we have

Sequence version

Theorem

Let (S, d_S) and (T, d_T) be metric spaces and $f : S \rightarrow T$ a function. Then f is continuous at a point p in S if for all sequences $\{x_n\}$ of values in S which converge to p , we have

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f(x_n) = f(p).$$

Sequence version

Theorem

Let (S, d_S) and (T, d_T) be metric spaces and $f : S \rightarrow T$ a function. Then f is continuous at a point p in S if for all sequences $\{x_n\}$ of values in S which converge to p , we have

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f(x_n) = f(p).$$

Intuitively, continuity means

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f(x_n) = f\left(\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} x_n\right).$$

Compositions

Theorem

Suppose (S, d_S) , (T, d_T) , and (U, d_U) are metric spaces and $f : S \rightarrow T$ and $g : T \rightarrow U$ are functions.

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Theorem

Suppose (S, d_S) , (T, d_T) , and (U, d_U) are metric spaces and $f : S \rightarrow T$ and $g : T \rightarrow U$ are functions.

If f is continuous at p and g is continuous at $f(p)$, then the composition $h = g \circ f : S \rightarrow U$ defined by $h(x) = g(f(x))$ is continuous at p .

Challenge!

Problem

Prove the previous theorem!

Preimages

Definition

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Preimages

Definition

Suppose $f : S \rightarrow T$ is a function and that $Y \subseteq T$.
The **inverse image** or **preimage** of Y is the set

$$f^{-1}(Y) = \{x : x \in S, \text{ and } f(x) \in Y\}.$$

Challenge!

Problem

Suppose that $S \rightarrow T$ and $Y \subseteq Z \subseteq T$.

Prove that

$$f^{-1}(Y) \subseteq f^{-1}(Z).$$

Open sets

Theorem

Suppose (S, d_S) and (T, d_T) are metric spaces and $f : S \rightarrow T$ is a function.

Open sets

Theorem

Suppose (S, d_S) and (T, d_T) are metric spaces and $f : S \rightarrow T$ is a function.

Then f is continuous if and only if $f^{-1}(V)$ is open for all open subsets $V \subseteq T$.

Closed sets

Theorem

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Closed sets

Theorem

Suppose (S, d_S) and (T, d_T) are metric spaces and $f : S \rightarrow T$ is a function.

Then f is continuous if and only if $f^{-1}(A)$ is closed for all closed subsets $A \subseteq T$.